DATA RETENTION AND PRIVACY POLICY - GERMANY

Meridian Logistics Group - Corporate Compliance Series, Document CP-DE-401

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines how Meridian Logistics Group collects, stores, retains and deletes personal and business records within its Germany operations. It applies to all employees, contractors and third-party processors handling data on behalf of the company in Germany. The policy exists to ensure lawful processing, to limit storage to what is necessary, and to guarantee that records are disposed of securely at the end of their lifecycle.

2. Definitions

Personal data means any information relating to an identified or identifiable natural person. Business records include contracts, invoices, correspondence, audit trails and operational logs produced in the course of business. A data breach is any security incident leading to accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, alteration or unauthorized disclosure of data.

3. Key Compliance Facts - Germany

Customer records retention period: 10 years from the end of the business relationship. Supervisory authority: the Federal Commissioner for Data Protection and Freedom of Information (BfDI). Maximum fine for non-compliance: EUR 20 million. Data breach notification deadline: 72 hours after becoming aware of the breach. Appointed Data Protection Officer: Dr. Anna Weber. Annual policy review month: March.

4. Storage and Security

All records must be stored on approved company systems with access restricted on a need-to-know basis. Encryption at rest and in transit is mandatory for personal data. Backup copies follow the same retention limits as primary records and are verified quarterly by the infrastructure team.

5. Deletion Procedure

When the retention period defined in section 3 expires, records are deleted during the monthly disposal window. Deletion requests are logged, and a certificate of destruction is produced for physical media. Exceptions require written approval from the Data Protection Officer and must reference an active legal hold.

6. Breach Response

Suspected breaches must be reported to the security desk immediately. The Data Protection Officer assesses severity and notifies the supervisory authority named in section 3 within

the deadline defined in section 3 when the breach poses a risk to data subjects. Affected individuals are informed without undue delay when the risk is high.